

CO-HOST BRIEFING

Minecraft Camping Escape Room

A high-level guide to running the event.

Everything you need, none of the wiring diagrams.



Lake Fairfax campsite - up to 6 explorers - ~75-100 min

The Big Picture

Thanks for helping run this. It's a Minecraft-themed adventure for a group of kids at Lake Fairfax campsite. The kids play as explorers hunting for a hidden Ender Dragon egg. The core idea: they start with nothing but an explorer's diary, and every tool has to be crafted before they can use it. They explore the campsite, collect hidden "blocks," and craft their way forward one tool at a time until they can open the locked treasure chest.

Players	Up to 6 kids, ages roughly 7-10
Length	About 75-100 minutes, start to finish
Vibe	Adventurous and silly, never scary. Daytime, outdoors
Setting	The campsite, tent, stream, trail, and bathroom ("the mine")
Goal	Craft your way to the Ender Dragon egg in the chest + treats

The whole thing runs on one core loop: find blocks out in the world, bring them back to the crafting table, place them in the right pattern, and craft the next tool. Each craft unlocks the next location or clue. The very first craft is the crafting table itself (that's the tutorial), and from there we repeat the loop about ten crafts total until the final craft (TNT) opens the treasure chest.

The Story

A long-lost explorer detected an Ender Dragon egg hidden near the campsite, then vanished. All they left behind is a diary. The kids pick up the trail. We read the diary's final entry aloud to kick things off, hand them the journal, and send them out to find 4 oak planks. Those planks are the "key" that gets them into the tent and lets them craft the crafting table, and the adventure builds from there.

The Moving Pieces

These are the props and gadgets that make it work. You don't need to know how any of the electronics are built, just what each thing is for.

- **Crafting Table:** the centerpiece, and the kids' first craft. A real 3x3 grid table with sensors in each slot. Kids place blocks and press to craft. It lights up, plays a sound, and pops a little door open to dispense the crafted tool. It lives in the tent for the whole game.
- **Blocks & Items:** about 50 3D-printed Minecraft blocks (wood, iron, sand, diamond, etc.). Each has a hidden tag the table reads. We hide these around the site before each run.
- **MCompass:** a real working compass they craft early on (step 2). Points the way for direction-card navigation.
- **Fog-of-War Map (iPad/phone):** not handed out at the start, it's crafted around the middle of the game (8 paper + a compass). Once crafted it "awakens" and reveals terrain as the kids walk, and we reveal block and location markers on it at the right moments.
- **Recipe Cards & Explorer's Journal:** printed cards show each craft's block pattern; journal pages are story flavor handed out as rewards along the way.
- **Creeper:** a stack of boxes painted green out on the trail. It's pre-scored so it falls apart when the kids "attack" it with the iron sword, dropping the gunpowder and TNT recipe. Not locked, just waiting to be found.
- **Treasure chest:** the finale prize, sitting locked in the tent in plain sight the whole game. The crafted TNT is what opens it, revealing the Ender Dragon egg and treats.

Your Role

You'll play the Villager, an in-world character the kids meet and trade with. No script to memorize, just a friendly camp character. If there's time we may add a simple villager nose to sell the part, but that's optional. Alongside the character, you're the game master's second set of hands. Your main jobs:

- The Villager trade: this is the one time you hand something to the kids. They bring you an emerald; you give them the amethyst shard and the Iron Sword recipe card. Otherwise the kids find things themselves, you don't hand out journal pages or other rewards.
- Reload the crafting-table doors: the table has 3 little doors that pop open to dispense a crafted prop, but there are more crafts than doors. After each craft, reload the next prop into that door so there's only ever one prop per slot at a time. Load order per door is below.
- Gatekeeper: several locations have signs like "Cobblestone Pickaxe Required." When the kids show up with the right crafted tool, let them in and point them to the loot hidden there.
- Sound & drama: play the creeper hiss and explosion sounds at the right moments, and "blow open" the locked treasure chest by unlocking it.
- Gentle nudges: if a group stalls, just wander over and drop a hint. Keep it casual, this is friends and family, not a competition.

Crafting-Table Door Reload Order

Each door is reused for several crafts. Start with the first prop loaded, then swap in the next one after each craft fires that door (one prop per slot at a time):

Door	Load in this order (craft #)
Door 0	Diamond Pickaxe (6) -> Spyglass (9)
Door 1	Cobblestone Pickaxe (3) -> Torch (7) -> TNT (10)
Door 2	MCompass (2) -> Fishing Pole (5) -> Iron Sword (8)

(The Crafting Table itself (1) and the Map (4) don't use a door, the

table craft is the tutorial and the map lights up the iPad.)

The Game Flow at a Glance

Ten crafts drive the adventure. Kids often gather blocks for several steps at once, so the exact order can wander, but this is the intended spine.

1. Crafting Table (tutorial): find 4 oak planks near camp, bring them to us. We let them into the tent and teach the craft mechanic. Tent holds iron, sticks, redstone, coal, the Compass recipe, and the chest they'll open at the very end.
2. Compass (4 iron + 1 redstone): crafting it hands them the MCompass plus the first direction card for waypoint navigation.
3. Cobblestone Pickaxe (3 cobblestone + 2 sticks): they gather cobblestone from the compass waypoints, then craft the pickaxe to unlock the Old Mine.
4. Map (8 paper + 1 compass): the big moment. The iPad map "awakens" and the world opens up. The compass block is consumed into the map.
5. Fishing Pole (3 sticks + 2 string): string comes from the mine and stream tacklebox. Lets them fish the stream.
6. Diamond Pickaxe (3 diamonds + 2 sticks): diamonds are fished out of the stream. Unlocks the Ancient Quarry.
7. Torch (1 coal + 1 stick): opens the Dark Cave (the bathroom stall).
8. Iron Sword (2 iron + 1 stick): the weapon for the creeper. Iron comes from the quarry; the sword recipe comes from trading an emerald to the villager.
9. Spyglass (1 amethyst + 2 copper): copper from the mine, amethyst from the villager trade. Used to spot the creeper's hiding spot.
10. TNT (5 gunpowder + 4 sand): gunpowder drops from the smashed creeper, sand from the stream shore. TNT "blows open" the treasure chest. Finale!

Finale

Kids bring the TNT to the locked chest in the tent. Play the explosion sound, unlock it, and reveal the 3D-printed Ender Dragon egg plus candy and treats for everyone.

Map Reveal Cues

The map starts almost blank and fills in as they progress. On the admin screen, reveal the next markers at these four beats:

When	Reveal on the map
Game start	Crafting table / start area
Map is crafted (step 4)	Mine, villager, stream, sand, key points
Spyglass moment (step 9)	Creeper location
Creeper defeated	The 5 gunpowder drop locations

Where Things Are

The natural setting doubles as Minecraft biomes. Rough layout:

- Campsite + Tent: home base. Crafting table and the finale chest live here.
- Forest (around camp): wood planks and sticks.
- Old Mine (bathroom stall, up the hill): paper, string, copper, coal. Pickaxe required.
- Stream: fishing spot for diamonds; sand along the shore.
- Ancient Quarry (rocks near camp): iron, emerald. Diamond pickaxe required.
- Villager (nearby clearing): trade an emerald for amethyst + sword recipe.
- Dark Cave (bathroom): spyglass recipe. Torch required.
- Trail / creeper spot: hidden until the spyglass sends them looking.
- Treasure chest (in the tent): holds the Ender Dragon egg + treats. Stays locked and in view the whole game until the TNT craft opens it.

Locked Locations

Each of these has a sign and stays "locked" until the kids arrive with the right crafted tool. That's your cue to let them in:

Location	Requires
Explorer Tent	Crafting Table (the 4 oak planks)
Old Mine	Cobblestone Pickaxe
Ancient Quarry	Diamond Pickaxe
Dark Cave	Torch
Creeper	Iron Sword
Treasure Chest	TNT

Running It Twice

We plan to run the adventure for two groups. Between runs we reset everything to its starting state. The short version:

- Collect all the blocks back and re-hide them in the same spots.
- Re-stock the tent (iron, redstone, coal, sticks) and re-lock the chest.
- Re-stack the creeper boxes (pre-scored, so they snap back together) and reload the 5 gunpowder + TNT recipe inside the head.
- Re-place the fishing container in the stream and reload the journal pages at each stop.
- Reset the map fog and re-hide all markers; reset the crafting table.
- Re-lock the chest with a fresh egg + treats inside so it's ready for the next group.

Safety Notes

Nothing here is risky, but a few things to keep an eye on:

- Stream is ankle-deep only. Fine for fishing, just keep it supervised.
- Sword and TNT are foam/props only, nothing that can actually hurt anyone.
- The creeper is built to fall apart when hit, not tip onto anyone, but give it a quick stability check before each run.
- Standard outdoor stuff: water, sunscreen, and a glance at the trail for poison ivy and trip hazards.

If in doubt

Find the game master. Home base is the tent with the crafting table. When you're not sure what unlocks next, the recipe cards and the map markers tell the story.